dictates of the IMF and the WB and becoming a party to promote ‘neo-imperialism’.

But these policies, in many cases proved little better than the previous policies in promoting growth over an extended period of time. But somehow a mood in favour of the market economy had gained ground. The United Kindom under Mrs. Thatcher had gone for politically most vocal privatisation moves without any political debates (The only such example of privatisation moves among the democracies, till date).[4] It should be noted here that after the Great Depression of 1929 a ‘strong state intervention’ was suggested (by J.M. Keynes) and such a policy did really help the Euro-American countries to mitigate the crisis. The favour for the state intervention in the economy was being reversed by the Washington Consensus. But soon this consensus was also to be replaced by another development strategy.

3. Mixed Economy

By the mid-1990s, it had become increasingly clear that neither of the extremes—the Washington Consensus or the state-led planned economy—were the ultimate strategies of development[5]. The success achieved by the East Asian economies even if we take into account their setback due to the financial crisis of 1997–98, stands out in marked contrast to the experiences of the other economies of the time who were following the Washington Concensus strategy of the planning model.[6] The East Asian economies have not only been able to propel higher growth rates but they have been greatly successful in reducing poverty, promoting education and healthcare, too.

The East Asian economies had promoted a development strategy which had its most distinctive feature as the balance they were able to strike between the roles of the state/government and the market/the private sector in their economies. This was really a new kind of the mixed economy which was never permanently inclined towards either state intervention or the free market, but always a balanced mix of the state and the market according to the requirement of the socioeconomic situation of the economy. The East Asian countries had pursued market-oriented policies that encouraged